Gmail

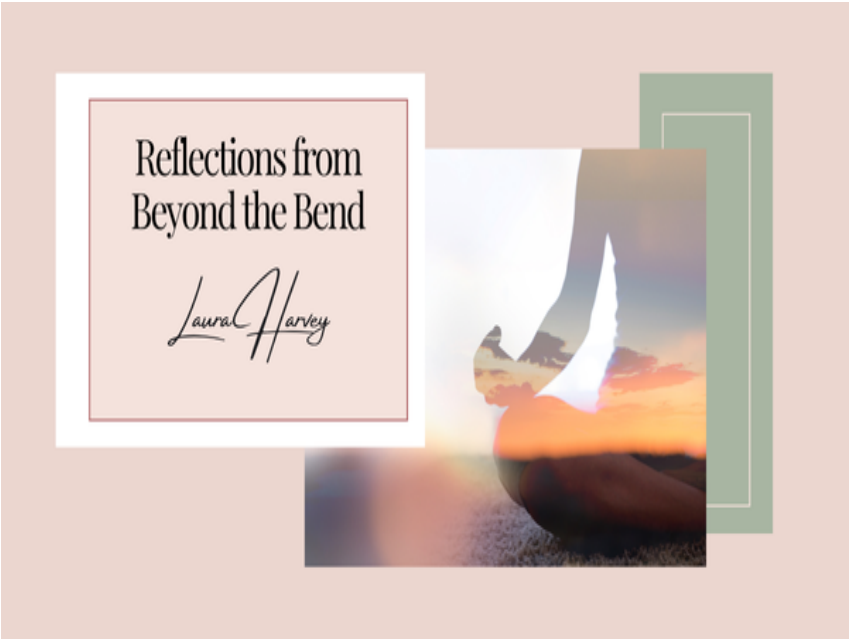
Laura Harvey <coachlharvey@gmail.com>

Reflections from Beyond the Bend

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Sun, Oct 12, 2025 at 10:02 AM
Reply-To: laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca
To: coachlharvey@gmail.com

BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hi Laura

We spend so much of our lives tending to relationships - with partners, friends, family - that we sometimes forget the one that quietly shapes them all: the relationship we have with ourselves.

That relationship begins to call for our attention and whispers beneath the noise of our days, asking us to slow down and listen. And when we finally do, something begins to shift, not because others change, but because we do.

This week's newsletter invites you to take that time for yourself, to tend gently to your inner world and see what's ready to grow.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

The Garden Within

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

There's a quote I love:

"You can only meet someone as deeply as you've met yourself." - Matt Kahn

Our connections are mirrors that are tender, revealing, sometimes uncomfortable. They reflect how we speak to ourselves, how safe we feel in our own company, and how much compassion we're willing to extend inward.

When we begin to see this truth clearly, it changes how we approach love - not as something to find, earn, or chase, but as something that begins within. The way we treat ourselves becomes the soil from which every other relationship grows.

Imagine, for a moment, our inner world as a garden. Every thought, every act of care, every boundary and breath becomes part of its landscape. Some days it may look lush and alive with new growth reaching toward the sun. Other days, it may feel untended and overgrown with old habits or dry from neglect.

This garden isn't a place to perfect. It's a place to notice.
To be curious about what's growing.
To acknowledge what's struggling

To acknowledge what's struggling.
To gently tend what needs attention.

When we nurture ourselves with gentleness and honesty, that energy naturally extends outward. It softens our tone, steadies our presence, and deepens our capacity to love others without losing ourselves. But when we neglect our inner garden - through self-criticism, avoidance, or over-giving - the soil becomes depleted. Even when love comes near, it can't quite take root.

Many of us learned long ago to earn love through doing, pleasing, or achieving. Those patterns were intelligent; they kept us connected in the ways we knew how. But as we grow older, they begin to feel heavy, as if the garden we've been tending was built to please everyone but ourselves.

Healing begins the moment we bring awareness to this cycle - when we pause, take a breath, and ask, What would it feel like to meet ourselves with curiosity instead of judgment?

That single question is like sunlight breaking through clouds. It doesn't demand that we fix or change - only that we notice, and allow. Each act of awareness becomes a drop of water for the roots of self-trust. Each kind thought becomes nourishment for the soil of our hearts.

Over time, the garden shifts. We begin to see new shoots of growth - boundaries formed from clarity rather than fear, choices made from love rather than guilt, tenderness that doesn't depend on anyone else's approval.

We don't need to be "fixed" or endlessly giving to be worthy of love. We only need to meet ourselves where we are - with patience, tenderness, and care.

Because when we do, our roots grow stronger. And from that fertile ground, every connection in our lives - with others, with the world, and with our own hearts - begins to bloom in a way that feels more peaceful, more authentic, and more true.

And as we tend this inner garden together, perhaps we'll remember that love, like sunlight, was never something we had to chase.

✨ Upcoming Classes

🌸 Sherwood Park - Rising Moon Studio

Evening Classes

- **Monday Evenings – Somatic Vinyasa (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 3 – December 15***
-
- **Tuesday Evenings – Restore and Reclaim (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 4 – December 16***

Drop-ins are available for Current Classes - Please Contact Laura at laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Morning Classes

- **Tuesday Mornings – Rise and Restore (10:00–11:15 a.m.)**
  October 21 – December 16 (9-week series)

Learn More and Sign-up

FREE CLASS - .TUESDAY OCT 14
Limited Space Available

Our **Free *Rise & Restore Yoga*** class at 10:00–11:15 a.m. **is now full** - thank you for the amazing response!

We've added a **second free class** from **11:45 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.** at **Rising Moon Studio** so more of you can join this relaxing, restorative morning. 🌸

Register for Your FREE Class

🌿 Edmonton - Center for Spiritual Living

- **Morning Stillness Yoga (Wed mornings 10:00–11:15 am)**
  October 29 – December 17 (8-week series)

Learn More and Sign-up

🌿 Practice of the Week: The Garden Within

Today's practice is a **guided meditation with built-in journaling reflection**, designed to help you reconnect with yourself through the image of your **inner garden** - a quiet, living space within where your energy, emotions, and intentions take root and grow.

As you move through the practice, you'll be invited to **pause and write** when prompted - gently tending to your inner landscape with curiosity and care. You'll explore what's thriving in your life right now, what's resting or being held in stillness, and what might be asking for a little more light - those tender parts of yourself ready to be seen, nourished, and reclaimed.

✨ **Before you begin**
Give yourself about **15 minutes** for the full experience. This is your time to **slow down and nurture yourself**, to listen inwardly and reconnect with what truly matters.

Find a **comfortable, quiet space** where you won't be disturbed. You might light a candle, wrap yourself in a cozy blanket, or bring something natural - a stone, a flower, or a plant - to help you feel grounded. Keep your **journal and pen** beside you for when the meditation invites you to reflect.

🎧 For the best experience, I recommend **listening with earphones** - it helps you fully immerse in the soundscape and stay present with your breath and inner imagery.

When you're ready, settle in, take a few slow breaths, and click below to begin.

🎧 https://youtu.be/w8hhyRlrcqw.

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Want to change how you receive these emails?
You can unsubscribe from this list.